

110.3 "OR"

"Or" is most often used to list two or more choices or alternatives.

Do you want to go to Germany **or** France?

"Or" is used if there is a choice.



"Or" can also be used to talk about the consequences (usually negative) of an action.

Don't be late, **or** you will miss the train.

"Or" is used to show that missing the train is a consequence of being late.



FURTHER EXAMPLES



Should we go out **or** should we stay at home instead?



Should we paint the kitchen blue **or** green?



I can't decide whether to get a dog **or** a cat.



Be careful when cooking, **or** you might burn yourself.

110.4 "NOR"

"Nor" shows that two or more things are not true or do not happen. After "nor," use a positive form of the verb, and invert the verb as for a question.

I've never eaten lobster, **nor** do I want to.

The subject comes after the verb.



FURTHER EXAMPLES



He can't play the guitar, **nor** can he sing.



Fiona didn't turn up to dinner, **nor** did she answer my calls.



My television doesn't work, **nor** does my stereo.

TIP

"Nor" is uncommon in informal English.